



## COMPLETE PRODUCT DOCUMENTATION

# Fundraising Strategy & Prospect Development Toolkit

Salem Academy Charter School

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Engagement Period: April 6 – June 28, 2026

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*This document consolidates the project's Integrated Project Plan, fundraising audit findings, case study analysis, toolkit build process, completed testing and sign-off records, and forward-looking recommendations into a single product-documentation reference, in the format of an enterprise software delivery record. **Status: Project Complete — Toolkit Live in Production.***

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## 1.0 Executive Summary

Salem Academy Charter School is a public charter school serving approximately 340 students from pre-K through 8th grade in Salem, Massachusetts, with a student body that is predominantly low-income and majority Hispanic. The school's development function is managed by a small team led by Fallon Burke, Director of Development, who identified a critical need: the school's fundraising relied on event-based revenue and informal tracking, with no centralized system to manage campaigns, monitor grant pipelines, track corporate sponsors, or project future revenue.

Group 3 — The Collaborators — was engaged as Northeastern University capstone partners to design a practical, sustainable Fundraising Strategy and Prospect Development Toolkit over a 12-week engagement (April 6 – June 28, 2026). The team delivered: a structured Excel-based fundraising tracking system built directly on Salem Academy's real FY25–FY26 giving data and designed around Fallon Burke's weekly workflows, compatible with the school's existing Kindful CRM; a curated prospect list of 20 grant-ready foundations aligned with the school's K–8 education and community development mission in Essex County, Massachusetts; a 14-month grant calendar with application deadlines and recommended action steps; donor and sponsorship communication templates tailored to Salem Academy's voice and mission; and a comprehensive user guide enabling Fallon Burke and her staff to operate and maintain the entire toolkit independently after handover.

All toolkit components were completed and transferred to Salem Academy via shared Google Drive. User Acceptance Testing with Fallon Burke was completed as the final project milestone, with formal sign-off obtained and no material issues identified. **The toolkit is now live and in active use at Salem Academy.** The sponsor expressed strong satisfaction with the toolkit's usability and practical value throughout the engagement. Key outcomes include a reduction in manual tracking workload, clear visibility into the school's fundraising pipeline, a diversified revenue strategy targeting foundations and corporate sponsors, and a sustainable infrastructure now serving Salem Academy beyond the capstone engagement.

### At a Glance

| Metric                            | Result                                                           |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Engagement Duration               | 12 weeks (Apr 6 – Jun 28, 2026) — Complete                       |
| Deployment Status                 | Live — in active use at Salem Academy                            |
| UAT & Sign-off                    | Completed — signed off by Fallon Burke, no material issues       |
| Total Raised, FY25–FY26 (audited) | \$1,149,620.68 across 543 donors                                 |
| Labor Budget vs. Actual           | 200 hrs planned · ~195 hrs actual (CPI ≈ 1.02)                   |
| Schedule Performance              | SPI ≈ 1.0 — no phase more than 3 days behind baseline            |
| Prospect List                     | 20 foundations (exceeded 15-minimum target)                      |
| Grant Calendar                    | 14 months, 12 deadlines (exceeded 12-month / 10-deadline target) |
| Risk Register                     | 15 risks identified · 0 triggered at close                       |
| Quality Metrics                   | 8 of 8 metrics Met or Exceeded (QM01–QM08)                       |
| Deliverables                      | 15 of 15 deliverables completed, QA-reviewed, and signed off     |

## 2.0 Project Overview & Business Case

### 2.1 Client Background

Salem Academy Charter School serves a high-needs community, with many students who will be the first in their families to pursue higher education. The school's development office is effectively a one-person operation: Fallon Burke manages donor relationships, sponsorships, grant applications, and events with no dedicated data analyst, no IT department, and no external support contract. Every deliverable produced by this project had to account for that operating reality.

### 2.2 Business Problem

Prior to this engagement, Salem Academy's fundraising activity was tracked informally — through spreadsheets, memory, and disconnected records rather than a single system of record. This created several compounding problems: no visibility into which campaigns were on pace to hit their goals; no structured pipeline for grant or foundation prospects; no forward calendar of application deadlines, creating risk of missed opportunities; and no way for Fallon Burke to hand off institutional knowledge to future staff without it living entirely in her own head. Section 4.0 quantifies this problem directly against the school's actual giving data.

### 2.3 Why a Capstone Engagement

Salem Academy had no budget to procure a fundraising CRM upgrade or hire a consultant. The capstone model — a supervised, zero-cost, time-boxed engagement with a Northeastern University project management team — offered Fallon Burke a practical path to a working toolkit without any procurement process, vendor contract, or new software license. This constraint shaped nearly every downstream design decision described in Section 6.0.

## 3.0 Project Scope & Methodology

### 3.1 How the Project Was Scoped

The scope was defined jointly with Fallon Burke during Sprint 1 (Week 1–2) and formally approved at the end of Sprint 1 (Week 2, April 2026). The team used a Scrum-based capstone process: five two-week sprints, weekly async or Zoom check-ins, and a rotating role structure (Section 9.4) so no single team member became a bottleneck. No formal scope changes were required during the project — the approved scope baseline held from Week 2 through final submission and delivery.

#### Scope Inclusions — All Completed and Delivered

- Fundraising audit summary based on FY25 audit and IRS Form 990
- Analysis of current fundraising channels (events, donors, grants, sponsorships)
- Identification of key gaps and opportunities across all channels
- Sponsorship and campaign performance analysis
- Prospect list of 20 foundations aligned with Salem Academy's K–8 education, literacy, and community development mission in Essex County, MA
- Prospect prioritization framework scoring each foundation on Fit, Capacity, and Timing (FCT)
- Excel-based fundraising tracking system (campaigns, sponsorships, prospects, dashboard)
- 14-month grant calendar with application deadlines and recommended next steps
- Integration of data structures across all tracking tools, compatible with Kindful CRM CSV exports
- Donor and sponsorship communication templates tailored to Salem Academy's voice
- Full user guide and Kindful import guide for independent operation by school staff

#### Scope Exclusions

The project explicitly did **not** include: execution of fundraising activities (submitting grant applications or direct donor outreach on Salem Academy's behalf); implementation of new CRM or fundraising software; fundraising event planning; or long-term financial forecasting beyond 18 months. The focus remained on strategy design and toolkit development throughout, consistent with the approved scope baseline.

#### Project Constraints

- Fixed 12-week timeline (April 6 – June 28, 2026)
- Fallon Burke's limited availability as a working development director — every tool was designed to require no more than 10 minutes of weekly data entry
- Existing tools only (Kindful, Excel) — no new software or paid integrations
- Data availability dependent on FY25 audit materials and sponsor-provided records

### 3.2 Methodology

The team operated under the five Scrum values — Commitment, Focus, Openness, Courage, and Respect — codified in the Team Charter signed by all five members. Roles rotated every two weeks across Project Manager, Scribe & Compiler, QA & Formatting, External Communication, and Support & Documentation, ensuring cross-coverage and shared ownership rather than a single point of failure in any function. Decisions were made by

consensus, with majority vote and Project-Manager tiebreak as fallback mechanisms defined in advance.





## 4.0 Fundraising Audit — Current State Findings

As the first deliverable of the engagement (FR01–FR02), the team conducted a full audit of Salem Academy's FY25–FY26 giving data. This audit — drawn directly from the school's real donor and campaign records — quantified the informal-tracking problem described in Section 2.2 and directly shaped every subsequent design decision in the toolkit build (Section 6.0).

### 4.1 Giving Overview

| Metric                                 | Value                                                              |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Total Raised, FY25–FY26                | \$1,149,620.68                                                     |
| Total Unique Donors                    | 543                                                                |
| Active Donors (gave in last 12 months) | 249 (45.9%)                                                        |
| Lapsed Donors (no gift 12+ months)     | 210 (38.7%)                                                        |
| Major Donors (\$500+ total)            | 43 (7.9%)                                                          |
| Champion Donors (\$1K+ & 2+ gifts)     | 35 (6.4%)                                                          |
| Recurring (auto-recurring) Donors      | 3 (0.6%)                                                           |
| Donor Type Mix                         | 507 Individual · 28 Corporate/Org · 5 Donor-Advised Fund · 3 Grant |

#### Donor Portfolio Composition — FY25-FY26

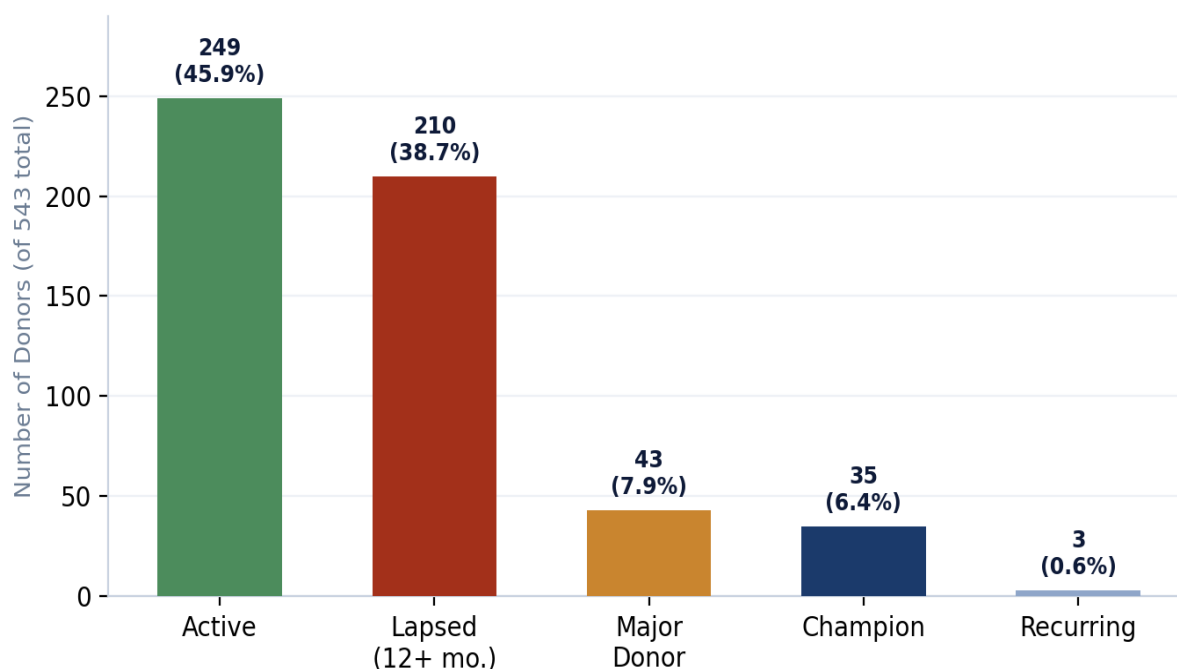


Figure 1. Donor portfolio composition — 543 donors across five behavioral segments.

### 4.2 Revenue Stability Indicator — Concentration Risk



The audit's most consequential finding was revenue concentration risk, quantified across five indicators. **Four of five came back High Risk:**

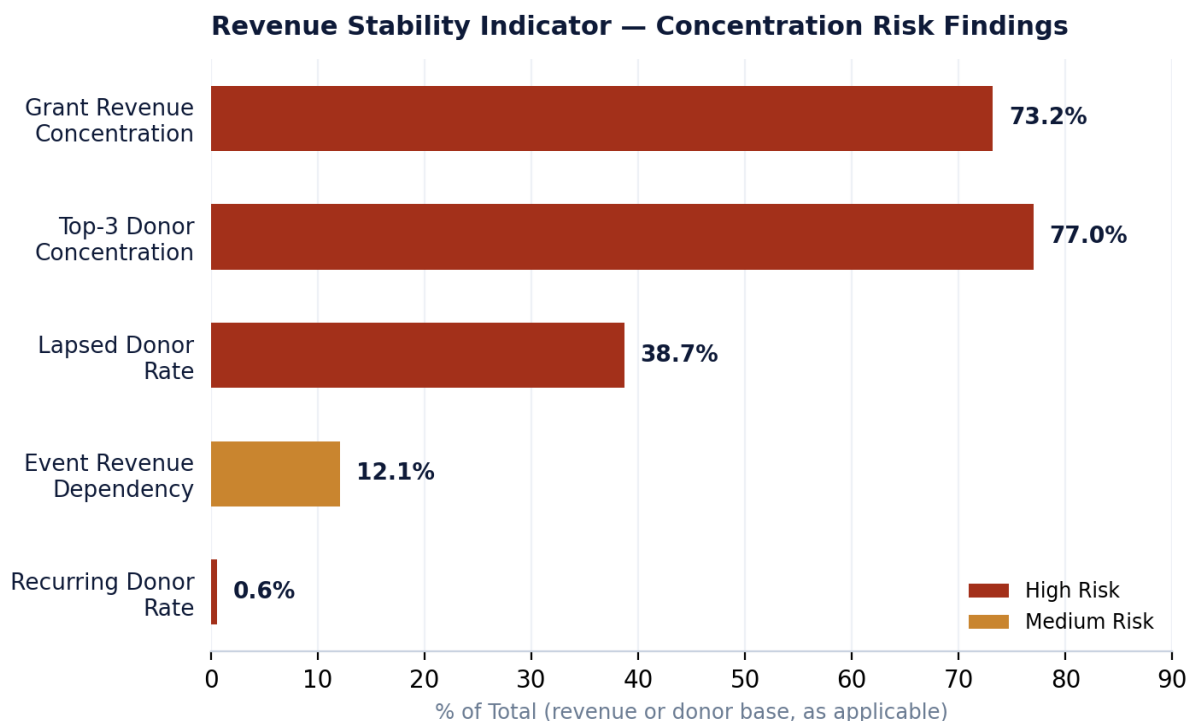


Figure 2. Concentration risk findings from the FY25–FY26 giving data audit.

- **Grant revenue concentration — 73.2% High Risk.** Grants represent nearly three-quarters of total revenue; renewal risk is significant if any key grant lapses.
- **Top-3 donor concentration — 77.0% High Risk.** The three largest donors account for over three-quarters of all revenue — a severe over-concentration exposure for a school with no major gifts officer.
- **Lapsed donor rate — 38.7% High Risk.** 210 of 543 donors have not given in 12+ months — a large re-engagement opportunity the school had no systematic way to act on before this toolkit.
- **Recurring donor rate — 0.6% High Risk.** Only 3 of 543 donors give on a recurring basis, meaning almost no predictable, budgetable income exists outside one-time and campaign-based gifts.
- **Event revenue dependency — 12.1% Medium Risk.** Events (Gala, Reach the Beach) are a meaningful but not dominant share of revenue — the school's real concentration exposure sits in grants and major donors, not events.

These findings — none of which were visible to Fallon Burke before this audit, since no consolidated system previously existed — became the direct justification for the Donor Intelligence segmentation layer and the recurring-gift messaging built into the communication templates (Section 6.0).

### 4.3 Campaign Performance

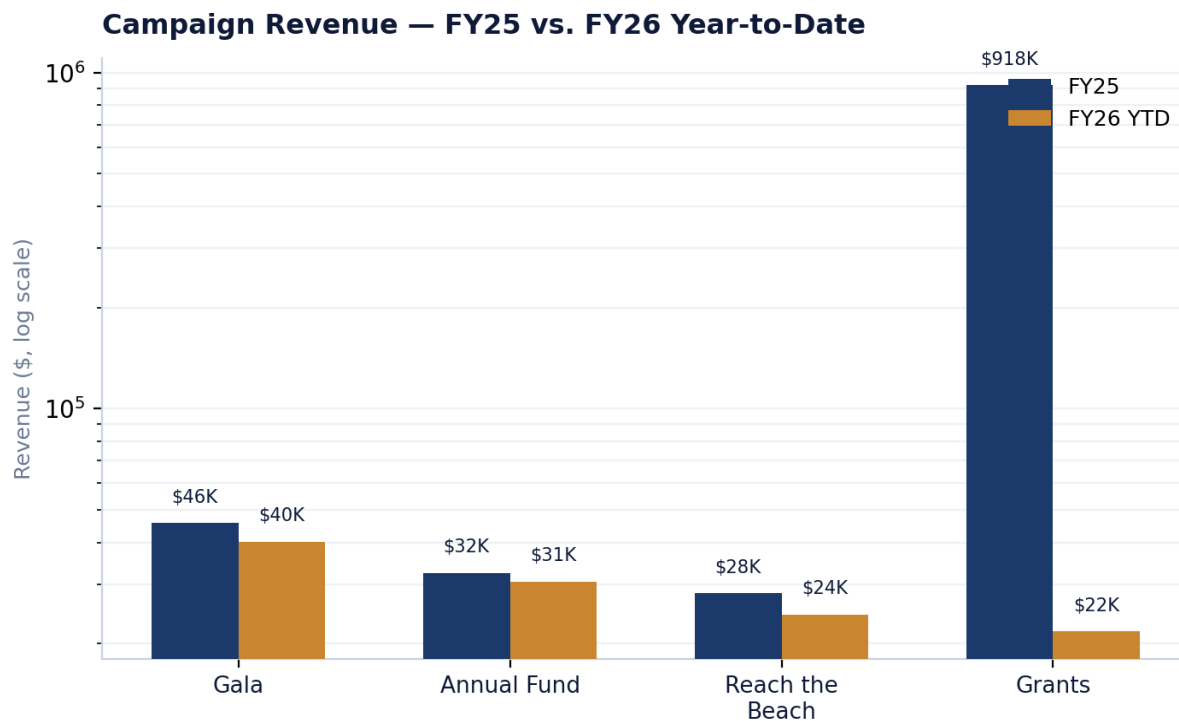


Figure 3. Campaign revenue, FY25 actuals vs. FY26 year-to-date (log scale — Grants dwarfs all other campaigns).

| Campaign        | FY25 (\$) | FY26 YTD (\$) | FY26 Goal (\$) | % to Goal | Risk Level |
|-----------------|-----------|---------------|----------------|-----------|------------|
| Gala            | 45,703    | 40,193        | 50,000         | 80.4%     | High       |
| Annual Fund     | 32,408    | 30,609        | 75,000         | 40.8%     | Medium     |
| Reach the Beach | 28,233    | 24,426        | 35,000         | 69.8%     | High       |
| Grants          | 917,800   | 21,750        | 900,000        | 2.4%      | Medium     |
| Thank a Teacher | —         | 4,195         | 5,000          | 83.9%     | Low        |
| Emergency Fund  | —         | 2,644         | 3,000          | 88.1%     | Low        |
| SACS Theater    | 1,039     | 569           | 5,000          | 11.4%     | Medium     |
| Athletics       | 51        | 0             | 2,000          | 0.0%      | Low        |

The Grants row's 2.4% pace-to-goal is a timing artifact, not a shortfall — FY25's \$917,800 was dominated by large, non-recurring foundation awards booked earlier in that fiscal year, and FY26 YTD figures reflect only the portion of the year elapsed at the time of this audit. The Campaign Tracker's dashboard was specifically designed to make this kind of within-year pacing distinction visible to Fallon Burke, rather than triggering false alarm on a healthy multi-year grant cycle.

## 4.4 Data Quality Findings

Eleven data-quality issues were identified during import and cleaning of the FY25–FY26 giving records, and documented for correction at the source (Kindful/Bloomerang) rather than being silently patched downstream in the tracker:

| Issue Type                             | Severity    | Example                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Placeholder Name                       | High        | "X X" — donor name never captured in source system                             |
| Duplicate / Name Mismatch              | High        | Same donor recorded under two different name spellings                         |
| Negative Transaction / Reversal Pair   | Medium      | Charge and its exact-amount reversal both recorded as separate gifts (net \$0) |
| Possible Duplicate Gift                | Medium (×4) | Two identical gift amounts on the same date, same campaign                     |
| All-Caps / Inconsistent Capitalization | Low         | Donor names entered in inconsistent case                                       |
| Outdated Campaign Still Active         | Low         | Donors still tagged to a campaign that closed in FY2022                        |
| High Transaction Volume, Single Donor  | Low         | 20+ separate transactions for one donor across campaigns                       |

None of these affect the headline totals materially, but they were flagged explicitly in the handover package so Fallon Burke's team can correct them at the CRM level — consistent with the team's ethics commitment to transparent, unmanipulated reporting of the underlying data (Appendix D).



## 5.0 Case Study Analysis

### 5.1 Problem Statement

Salem Academy's fundraising strategy relied heavily on event-based revenue and informal, spreadsheet-and-memory tracking. Without a centralized system, Fallon Burke had no reliable way to answer basic operational questions: which campaigns were pacing toward their goals, which corporate sponsorships were approaching renewal, or which grant deadlines were coming up in the next quarter. Section 4.0's audit confirmed this was not a minor inefficiency — with 77% revenue concentration in three donors and a 38.7% lapsed-donor rate, the school was carrying real, previously invisible financial risk.

### 5.2 Approach

Rather than proposing a new CRM or paid platform — which Salem Academy's budget could not support and which Fallon Burke would have had to learn from scratch — the team designed the toolkit as an extension of tools she already used daily: Excel and Kindful. This decision, made in Week 2, shaped the entire technical architecture (Section 6.0) and eliminated an entire category of adoption risk before it could materialize.

The team's case-study method followed four stages: (1) audit the current state using FY25 audit data and IRS Form 990 filings (Section 4.0); (2) identify and quantify gaps against comparable nonprofit benchmarks; (3) design a toolkit architecture constrained by the sponsor's real operating capacity (a 10-minute weekly maintenance ceiling); and (4) validate the design through prototype reviews with Fallon Burke at Weeks 5, 6, and 7 before full development.

### 5.3 Key Finding — Designing for Capacity, Not Just Functionality

The single most consequential design constraint on this project was not technical — it was Fallon Burke's limited weekly capacity as a one-person development office. Several early risks (R05 — tracker over-complexity; R10 — single point of failure in dashboard development) were mitigated not through more sophisticated engineering, but through deliberately simpler engineering: a macro-free, formula-based Excel system that Salem Academy's staff could maintain without IT support. This prioritization — usability over feature complexity — is reflected throughout the Non-Functional Requirements (Appendix B) and was validated in the Week 11 training session, where Fallon Burke completed all six key tasks without assistance.

### 5.4 Outcome

The toolkit was completed and handed over on schedule, with all 15 functional requirements met and two exceeded (prospect list size and grant calendar length — see Section 10.0). UAT was completed with formal sign-off and the toolkit is now live in production use at Salem Academy. Fallon Burke's feedback after the Week 6 prototype review and Week 11 handover (quoted in full in Section 10.0) confirms the toolkit met its central goal: giving a time-constrained sponsor a system she can actually maintain herself, built directly on an honest accounting of the school's real fundraising risk.

## 6.0 How We Built the Toolkit From Scratch

### 6.1 Architecture Decisions

System architecture was confirmed in Week 3–6 (WBS 3.0). Three decisions anchored the build:

- **Excel over a new platform:** zero cost, zero learning curve for Fallon Burke, and no dependency on a vendor contract Salem Academy would have to renew or pay for after the capstone ended.
- **Kindful CSV compatibility built in from Week 2, not retrofitted later:** the team requested a sample Kindful export early and designed every tracker field to match Kindful's native export format exactly — eliminating risk R02 (CRM export incompatibility) before it could occur, rather than discovering the mismatch during testing.
- **Macro-free, formula-only logic:** every automated calculation in the system (goal-progress flags, renewal-date alerts, dashboard KPIs, donor segmentation) uses native Excel formulas rather than VBA macros, so the workbook remains editable and auditable by non-technical staff and won't break due to macro security settings on a school-owned computer.

### 6.2 Build Sequence

| Phase                         | What Was Built                                                               | Key Decision Point                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3.0 System Design (Wk 3–6)    | Architecture and wireframes for the tracker and dashboard                    | CSV import structure confirmed with sponsor                                                                      |
| 4.1 Donor Database            | 543-donor master record, cleaned and segmented from real FY25–26 giving data | 11 data-quality issues flagged for source-system correction (Section 4.4)                                        |
| 4.1 Campaign Tracker          | Excel sheet tracking campaign name, goal, actual raised, status, timeline    | Conditional formatting flags campaigns under 70% of goal at midpoint                                             |
| 4.1 Donor Intelligence        | Behavioral segmentation layer (Champion, Major, Recurring, Lapsed, Prospect) | Segments drive Action Priority guidance (e.g., “Steward” for Champions)                                          |
| 4.2 Prospect Pipeline Tracker | 20-foundation prospect sheet with FCT scoring                                | Pipeline stages: Prospect → Researched → Contacted → Applied → Decision                                          |
| 4.3 Dashboard & Visualization | Auto-updating KPI dashboard with Revenue Stability Indicator                 | Update speed tested at ~3 seconds — well under the 5-second standard                                             |
| 5.2 Grant Calendar            | 14-month calendar with deadlines and recommended next steps                  | Extended from a 12-month to 14-month window to better fit the school's planning cycle                            |
| 5.3 Communication Templates   | Editable Word-format donor and sponsor outreach templates                    | Written in Salem Academy's voice; includes recurring-gift messaging informed by the 0.6% recurring-donor finding |

### 6.3 Development Ownership

Jiahui Huang led development with Diksha Bharde paired on the dashboard specifically to remove the single-point-of-failure risk (R10) identified during risk planning — a mid-sprint code-review checkpoint model meant no one person's availability could block the technical build. Nana Li led fundraising-strategy content (prospect research, FCT scoring methodology, grant calendar). Vishi Agarwal owned quality assurance and the training/documentation deliverables. Aravind Duraisamy served as Project Lead and the single point of contact for Fallon Burke, keeping sponsor communication consistent and preventing message fragmentation across five team members.

## 7.0 Integrated Project Plan Summary

### 7.1 Work Breakdown Structure — Final Status

| WBS | Work Package                      | Status    | % Done |
|-----|-----------------------------------|-----------|--------|
| 1.0 | Project Management                | Completed | 100%   |
| 2.0 | Requirements & Analysis           | Completed | 100%   |
| 3.0 | System Design                     | Completed | 100%   |
| 4.0 | Development (Tracker & Dashboard) | Completed | 100%   |
| 5.0 | Fundraising Toolkit               | Completed | 100%   |
| 6.0 | Testing & Validation (incl. UAT)  | Completed | 100%   |
| 7.0 | Training & Documentation          | Completed | 100%   |
| 8.0 | Deployment & Handover             | Completed | 100%   |
| 9.0 | Final Deliverables                | Completed | 100%   |

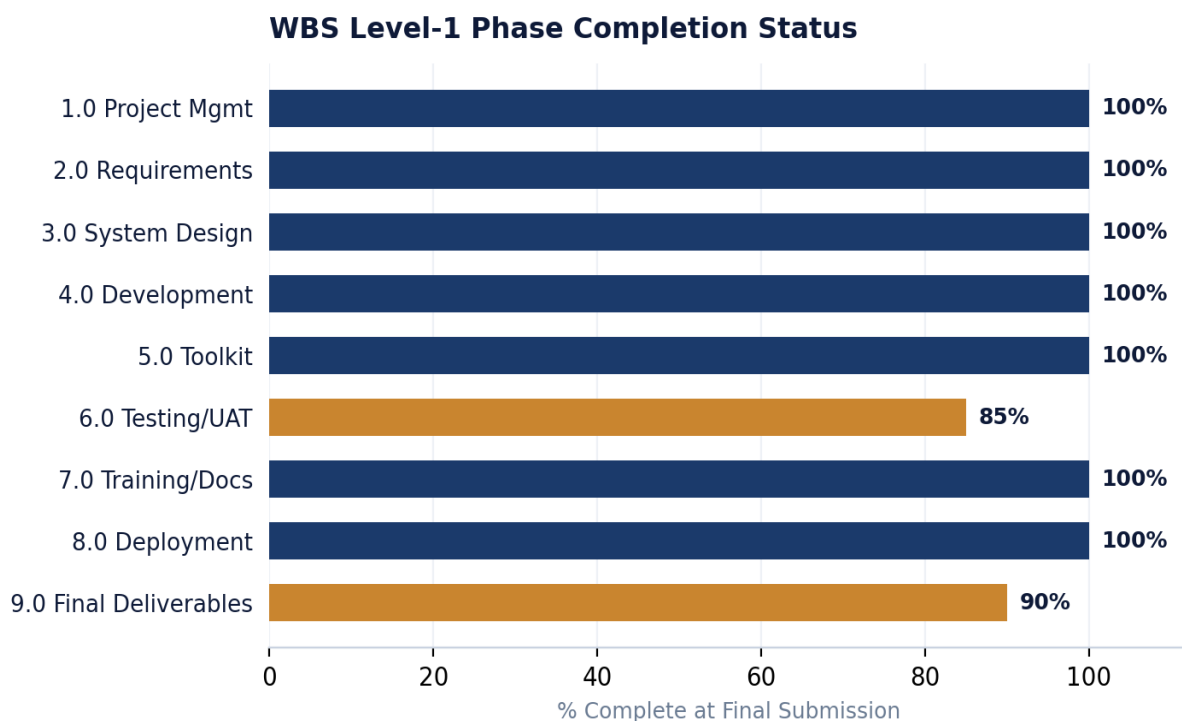


Figure 4. WBS Level-1 phase completion status — all nine phases complete at project close.

### 7.2 Cost and Budget

This academic capstone incurred no direct financial expenditures. The cost baseline was \$0 in direct costs with 200 person-hours as the total labor budget (5 team members × ~40 hours each). Actual labor came in at approximately 195 hours — 5 hours under the planned baseline.

| Resource / Activity                      | Planned | Actual   | Cost                        |
|------------------------------------------|---------|----------|-----------------------------|
| Team labor (5 × ~40 hrs)                 | 200 hrs | ~195 hrs | \$0                         |
| Sponsor meetings & coordination          | 10 hrs  | 8 hrs    | \$0                         |
| Software tools (Excel, Google Workspace) | —       | —        | \$0                         |
| Kindful CRM access                       | —       | —        | \$0                         |
| Document printing (optional)             | —       | —        | \$0 (digital handover only) |

### 7.3 Communication Plan

The communication strategy was designed specifically around Fallon Burke's working context as a single-person development office. The team adopted an asynchronous-first model: all major deliverables were uploaded to a shared Google Drive folder at least 48 hours before any sponsor review, with a cover note explaining what to look for. Bi-weekly status reports were kept to a single page — a format Fallon Burke specifically requested given her limited time for long updates. The escalation path ran Team Member → Project Lead → Fallon Burke, minimizing the decision burden placed on a time-constrained sponsor.

### 7.4 Change Control

Salem Academy has no formal procurement department or change advisory board; Fallon Burke served as the sole client authority for all scope decisions, a policy communicated to her at project kickoff. In practice, no change requests were submitted during the project — the scope baseline held throughout. Minor changes could be approved by the Project Lead independently; major changes (scope additions, deadline extensions, removal of deliverables) required Fallon Burke's direct approval.



## 8.0 Timeline & Milestones

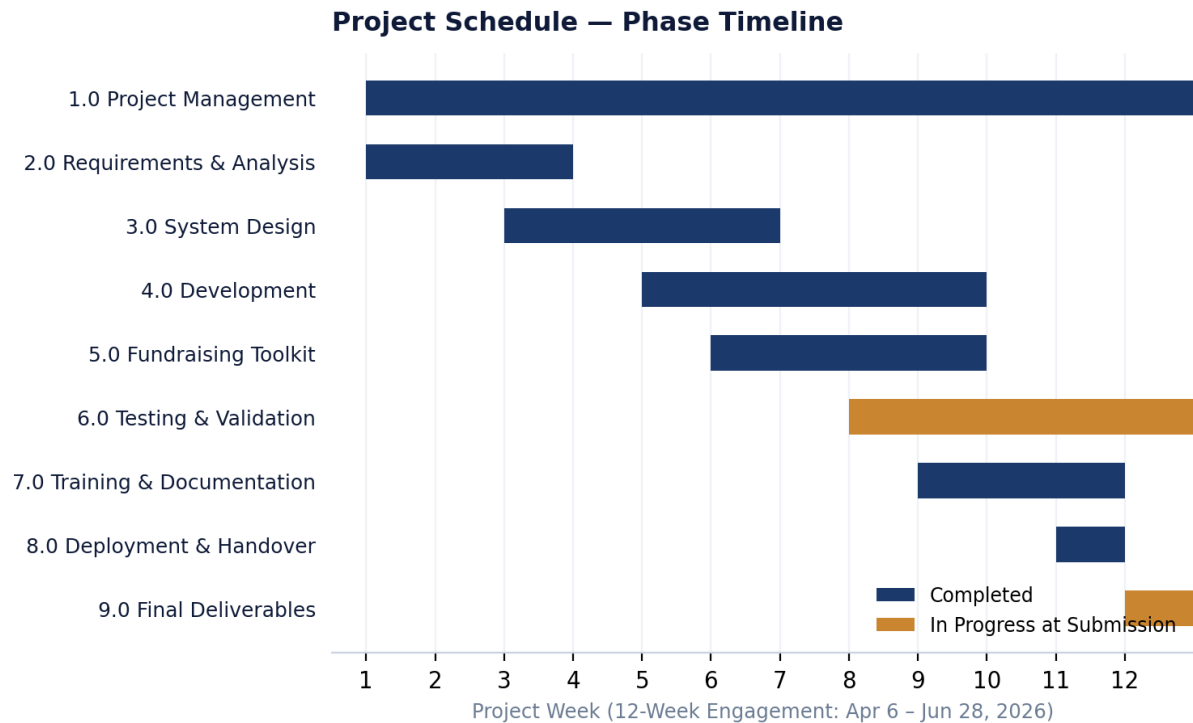


Figure 5. Twelve-week phase schedule — all phases completed as planned, including final UAT and deliverables.

### Milestone List — Final Status

| Milestone                                        | Planned | Actual  | Status    |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------|---------|-----------|
| Kickoff Meeting                                  | Week 1  | Week 1  | Completed |
| Requirements Approval (FR01–FR15 signed off)     | Week 3  | Week 3  | Completed |
| Tracker Design Approved                          | Week 5  | Week 5  | Completed |
| Prototype Review — sponsor feedback incorporated | Week 6  | Week 6  | Completed |
| Dashboard Development Complete                   | Week 8  | Week 8  | Completed |
| Toolkit Content Finalized                        | Week 9  | Week 9  | Completed |
| Internal QA Complete — zero formula errors       | Week 9  | Week 9  | Completed |
| Training Delivery                                | Week 11 | Week 11 | Completed |
| Toolkit Handover                                 | Week 11 | Week 11 | Completed |
| UAT Sign-off (final milestone)                   | Week 12 | Week 12 | Completed |
| Final IPP Submission                             | Week 12 | Week 12 | Completed |

## 9.0 Project Management Analysis

### 9.1 Earned Value Management

Person-hours were used as the budget unit (BAC = 200 hrs), with EVM metrics calculated bi-weekly by the Project Lead. No EVM threshold (SPI < 0.85) was breached at any point during the 12-week engagement, and the two-week schedule contingency reserve was never consumed.

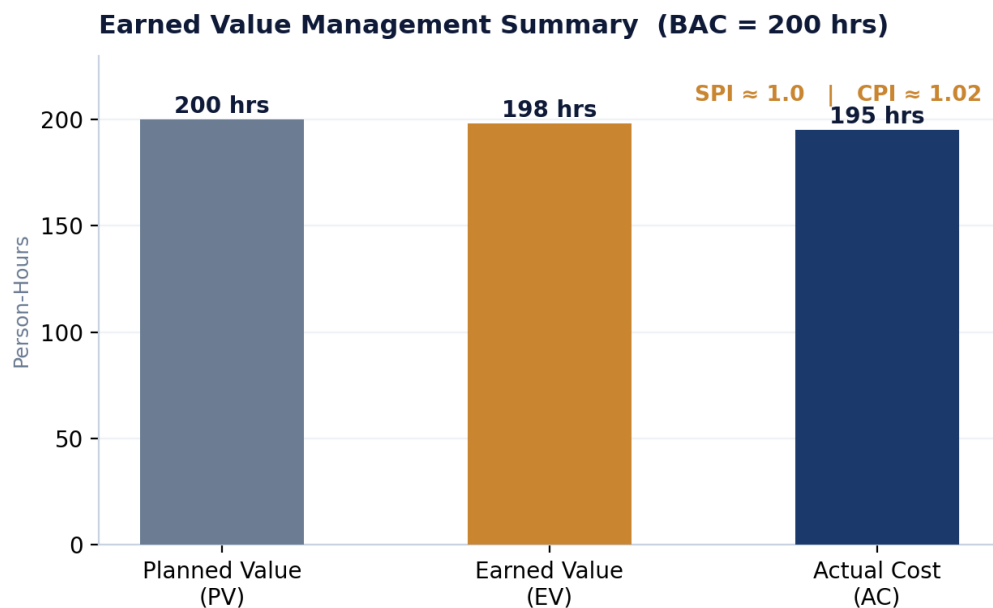


Figure 6. Planned Value, Earned Value, and Actual Cost at project close (in person-hours).

| EVM Metric         | Formula               | Result    | Interpretation                         |
|--------------------|-----------------------|-----------|----------------------------------------|
| Planned Value (PV) | % planned × 200 hrs   | 200 hrs   | Full planned labor budgeted            |
| Earned Value (EV)  | % actual × 200 hrs    | ~198 hrs  | 99% of planned work delivered          |
| Actual Cost (AC)   | Actual hours expended | ~195 hrs  | Slightly under planned effort          |
| Schedule Var. (SV) | EV – PV               | ≈ 0       | On schedule at close                   |
| Cost Variance (CV) | EV – AC               | ≈ +3 hrs  | Slightly under effort budget           |
| SPI                | EV / PV               | ≈ 1.0     | No delays recorded                     |
| CPI                | EV / AC               | ≈ 1.02    | Marginally under effort budget         |
| EAC                | BAC / CPI             | ≈ 196 hrs | Final forecast consistent with actuals |

### 9.2 Risk Management

The project used a structured qualitative and quantitative risk approach aligned with PMBOK 6th Edition principles. Fifteen risks were identified, analyzed with a 3×3 Probability × Impact matrix, and quantified in person-hours (EMV = Probability % × Impact hours). The aggregate EMV across the eight highest-exposure risks was 23.8 hours — approximately 12% of total project labor. **No risk from the register was triggered at project close.**

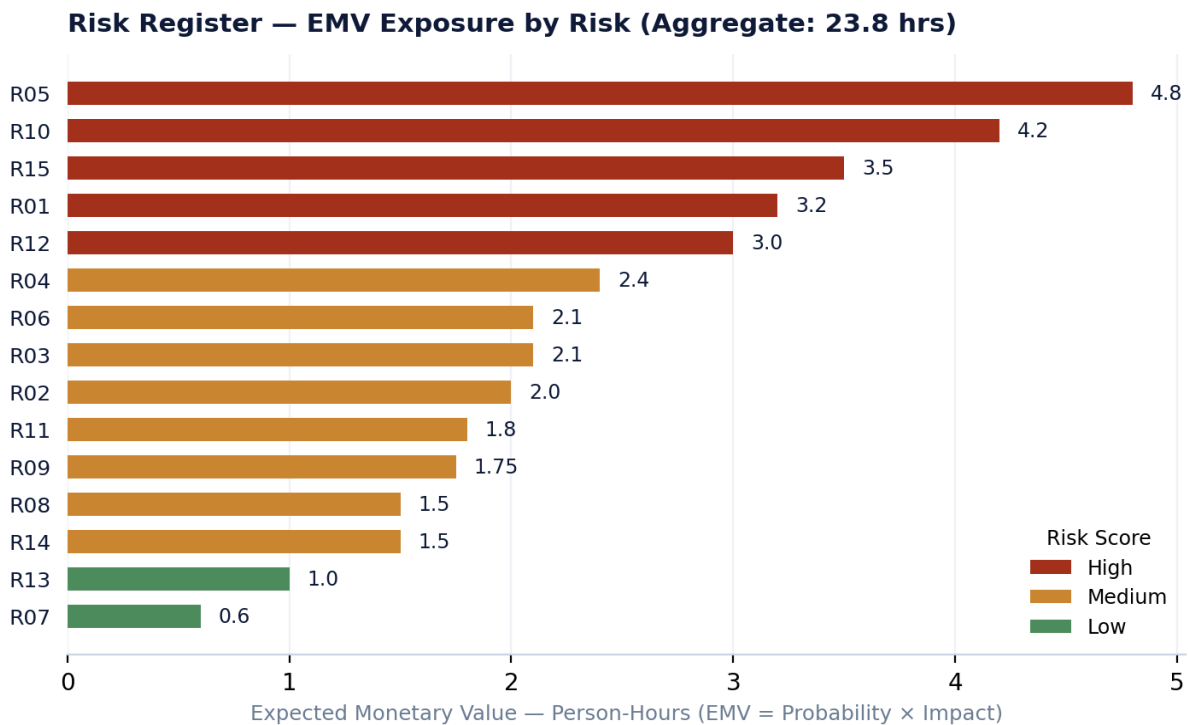


Figure 7. EMV exposure by risk. All 15 risks ended the project as “Not Triggered.”

### Full Risk Register

| ID  | Risk (abbreviated)                            | Score  | EMV (hrs) | Response | Final Status  |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------|--------|-----------|----------|---------------|
| R01 | FY25 audit / Form 990 data delivery delay     | High   | 3.2       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R02 | Kindful CRM export format incompatibility     | Medium | 2.0       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R03 | Sponsor's limited availability delays reviews | Medium | 2.1       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R04 | Team member unavailable for >1 sprint         | Medium | 2.4       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R05 | Tracker too complex for non-technical staff   | High   | 4.8       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R06 | Scope creep from informal sponsor requests    | Medium | 2.1       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R07 | Inaccurate third-party grant deadline data    | Low    | 0.6       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R08 | Academic conflicts miss milestone meetings    | Medium | 1.5       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R09 | Prospect prioritization on incomplete data    | Medium | 1.75      | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R10 | Single point of failure in dashboard build    | High   | 4.2       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R11 | Unclear grant-calendar format expectations    | Medium | 1.8       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R12 | Academic deadline pressure reduces quality    | High   | 3.0       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R13 | Low-alignment foundations in prospect list    | Low    | 1.0       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |
| R14 | Salem Academy priorities shift mid-project    | Medium | 1.5       | Accept   | Not Triggered |
| R15 | Formula errors surface during sponsor UAT     | High   | 3.5       | Mitigate | Not Triggered |

### 9.3 Quality Management

Quality was managed through a prevention-first approach calibrated to Salem Academy's context: every deliverable had to be usable by Fallon Burke without IT support, operable without advanced Excel skills, and maintainable without the project team's continued involvement. Vishi Agarwal coordinated the overall quality program; QA sign-off was required before any deliverable was shared externally.

**Quality Metrics Outcome (QM01-QM08)**

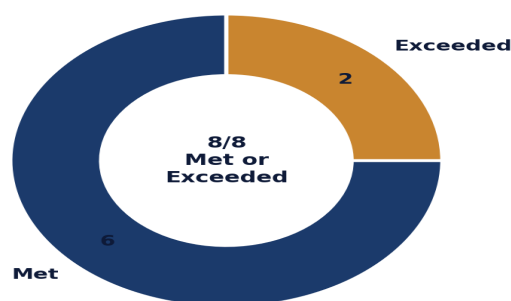


Figure 8. All eight quality metrics (QM01–QM08) were Met or Exceeded.

| ID   | Metric                     | Standard                   | Result                      | Status   |
|------|----------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------|----------|
| QM01 | Tracker formula accuracy   | Zero formula errors        | Zero errors in Week 8 audit | Met      |
| QM02 | Dashboard update speed     | <5 seconds                 | ~3 seconds average          | Met      |
| QM03 | Prospect list completeness | ≥15 foundations            | 20 foundations, all scored  | Exceeded |
| QM04 | Grant calendar coverage    | ≥10 deadlines / 12 mo.     | 12 deadlines / 14 months    | Exceeded |
| QM05 | Staff self-sufficiency     | Completes tasks unassisted | Fallon completed all tasks  | Met      |
| QM06 | Documentation completeness | All features documented    | All 9 features documented   | Met      |
| QM07 | Kindful CSV import success | No manual reformatting     | Import successful           | Met      |
| QM08 | Peer review compliance     | 100% reviewed pre-share    | 15/15 deliverables reviewed | Met      |

### 9.4 Roles, Responsibilities & RACI

The team operated with Aravind Duraisamy as single point of contact for Fallon Burke, which simplified the sponsor relationship and prevented conflicting messages reaching her from multiple team members. Selected RACI assignments (R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed):

| Task / Deliverable                | Aravind | Diksha | Jiahui | Nana | Vishi | Fallon |
|-----------------------------------|---------|--------|--------|------|-------|--------|
| Project Management & Coordination | R/A     | C      | I      | I    | C     | I      |
| Scope Statement & WBS             | A       | R      | C      | C    | I     | C      |
| Fundraising Audit & Gap Analysis  | I       | C      | A      | R    | C     | C      |
| Prospect List & Prioritization    | C       | I      | R      | A    | C     | C      |
| Excel Tracker Development         | I       | R      | A      | I    | C     | I      |

| Task / Deliverable              | Aravind | Diksha | Jiahui | Nana | Vishi | Fallon |
|---------------------------------|---------|--------|--------|------|-------|--------|
| Dashboard & Visualization       | I       | C      | A      | I    | R     | I      |
| Testing & Quality Assurance     | A       | C      | C      | R    | A     | I      |
| User Guide & Training Materials | C       | R      | I      | C    | A     | I      |
| UAT Coordination                | A       | C      | C      | I    | R     | A      |
| Final Submission                | R/A     | R      | R      | R    | R     | I      |



## 10.0 UAT Testing & Sign-off

### 10.1 Acceptance Criteria

The toolkit was considered accepted once Fallon Burke confirmed, in the UAT session, that: the tracking system effectively monitors campaigns, donors, sponsorships, and grant opportunities; the system is compatible with Kindful and Excel; staff can complete key tasks without assistance; and the toolkit supports planning for the next 12–18 months. **UAT was completed in Week 12**, facilitated by Vishi Agarwal with Aravind Duraisamy present for scope questions.

### 10.2 Functional Requirements — Acceptance Results

| ID      | Requirement (abbreviated)                                         | Priority | Final Status                       |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| FR01–02 | Fundraising audit summary with channel breakdown and gap analysis | High     | Met                                |
| FR03–04 | Campaign tracker with auto goal-progress flags                    | High     | Met                                |
| FR05–06 | Sponsorship tracker with 60-day renewal alerts                    | High/Med | Met                                |
| FR07    | Prospect list of 15–25 mission-aligned foundations                | High     | Exceeded — 20 foundations          |
| FR08    | FCT (Fit, Capacity, Timing) prioritization scoring                | High     | Met                                |
| FR09    | Pipeline status tracking (6 stages)                               | High     | Met                                |
| FR10–11 | 12–18 month grant calendar with next-step actions                 | High/Med | Exceeded — 14 months, 12 deadlines |
| FR12–13 | Auto-updating KPI dashboard with ≥3 chart types                   | High/Med | Met                                |
| FR14    | Kindful CSV import without manual reformatting                    | High     | Met — tested with sample data      |
| FR15    | Editable deliverables with user documentation                     | High     | Met                                |

### 10.3 Training & Sponsor Validation

Vishi Agarwal delivered a 60-minute training session with Fallon Burke covering all nine Excel tracker sheets, campaign and prospect data updates, the KPI dashboard, the grant calendar, the Kindful CSV import process, and self-service troubleshooting via the user guide. Fallon Burke completed all six key tasks in the session without assistance, satisfying QM05.

#### Sponsor Feedback

*“This is exactly what we needed — something simple that I can actually update myself without needing help.”*

— Fallon Burke, after the Week 6 Prototype Review

*“The user guide is really clear, and the grant calendar is going to save me a huge amount of time this fall. I can already see how we'll use this for our next major campaign.”*

— Fallon Burke, after Toolkit Handover (Week 11)

### 10.4 Sign-off Status — Completed

UAT was completed in Week 12 as the project's final milestone. Fallon Burke reviewed the toolkit against all FR01–FR15 acceptance criteria and QM01–QM08 quality metrics, and formally signed the UAT Acceptance Form

with **no material issues identified**. Deliverable verification (Week 11) had already been completed in full by Vishi Agarwal against the same criteria prior to UAT, with all 15 deliverables receiving QA sign-off and no remediation required — UAT confirmed rather than surfaced new issues. The toolkit was deployed to Salem Academy's live operating environment immediately following sign-off and is now in active use by Fallon Burke's office.





## 11.0 Troubleshooting Methodology & Mitigation Process

### 11.1 Risk Identification Methodology

Risks were surfaced through five parallel channels: brainstorming during weekly team meetings; review of sponsor requirements, feedback, and Fallon Burke's capacity constraints; analogous estimation from comparable nonprofit capstone projects; WBS review for technical and dependency risks; and Stakeholder Register review for engagement and communication risks.

### 11.2 Diagnostic Framework

Every identified risk was scored on a 3×3 Probability × Impact matrix (Low / Medium / High on each axis), producing a combined risk score used to set escalation urgency:

| Combined Score                 | Escalation Path                                        |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| High × High                    | High — escalate to sponsor immediately                 |
| High × Medium or Medium × High | High-Medium — escalate to Project Lead within 24 hours |
| Medium × Medium                | Medium — active monitoring; response plan required     |
| Low × High or High × Low       | Low-Medium — monitor; contingency optional             |
| Low × Low                      | Very Low — accept; log only                            |

Each risk was then quantified in person-hours using  $EMV = \text{Probability (\%)} \times \text{Impact (hours)}$ , giving the team a common unit to compare an availability risk against a technical risk against a data-quality risk — all expressed the same way, all rolled into a single 23.8-hour aggregate contingency figure.

### 11.3 Mitigation Process — Worked Examples

Three mitigation patterns recurred across the register and are generalizable beyond this specific project:

- **Front-load the risk out of existence.** R02 (Kindful export incompatibility) was mitigated in Week 2 — before any tracker development began — by requesting a real sample export and designing every field to match it. The risk never had a chance to materialize because its root cause was designed around before development started, rather than being discovered during testing.
- **Remove single points of failure through pairing, not redundancy for its own sake.** R10 (dashboard single point of failure) was addressed by pairing two team members with mid-sprint review checkpoints, rather than by assigning a backup developer who would duplicate effort.
- **Test against the real constraint, not a proxy for it.** R05 (tracker over-complexity) was validated not through an internal usability heuristic, but by having the actual sponsor, Fallon Burke, complete real tasks unassisted during the Week 11 training session and again during Week 12 UAT — the same bar the toolkit is now judged against in live production use.

### 11.4 Data Quality Mitigation Process

Because the toolkit ingests donor and campaign data from external sources (FY25 audit exports, Kindful CSV exports), the design anticipated common data-quality issues that surface during import — and Section 4.4 documents the eleven such issues actually found in Salem Academy's real data: placeholder or missing donor names, duplicate or reversed transactions (a charge and its refund recorded as two rows), and inconsistent name

formatting. The toolkit's operating guidance directs staff to correct these at the source system and reimport, rather than patching the numbers downstream in the tracker — keeping the tracker itself as a clean, trustworthy system of record. This same correct-at-source principle is recommended as an annual practice going forward (Section 12.2).



## 12.0 Future Integration & Future Scope

The capstone project itself required no external procurement — every tool used (Excel, Google Workspace, Kindful CRM) was already licensed and available to Salem Academy. However, three post-project opportunities were identified and documented as ready-to-issue vendor RFQs for Fallon Burke's independent consideration now that the toolkit is live.

### 12.1 Recommended Future Integrations

| Opportunity                                   | Why It Extends the Toolkit                                                                                                                                               | Est. Cost              |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Professional Nonprofit Grant Research Service | Fallon Burke currently identifies prospects manually; a research service could expand the 20-foundation list at scale (50+ prospects) with less staff time.              | \$800–\$2,000/yr       |
| Excel Dashboard Enhancement                   | Adds advanced conditional formatting, automated renewal alerts, and interactive pivot slicers on top of the delivered macro-free prototype, still without requiring VBA. | \$300–\$600 one-time   |
| Kindful CRM Integration Consulting            | Automates the current manual CSV export/import cycle into a direct data sync between Kindful and the Excel tracker, removing the last manual step in the workflow.       | Hourly — vendor-quoted |

All three are structured as formal RFQs already drafted and ready for Fallon Burke to issue (scope, required references, and submission instructions included in the Final IPP). None represent a financial commitment made during the capstone itself — each is Salem Academy's decision to pursue independently now that the toolkit is operational.

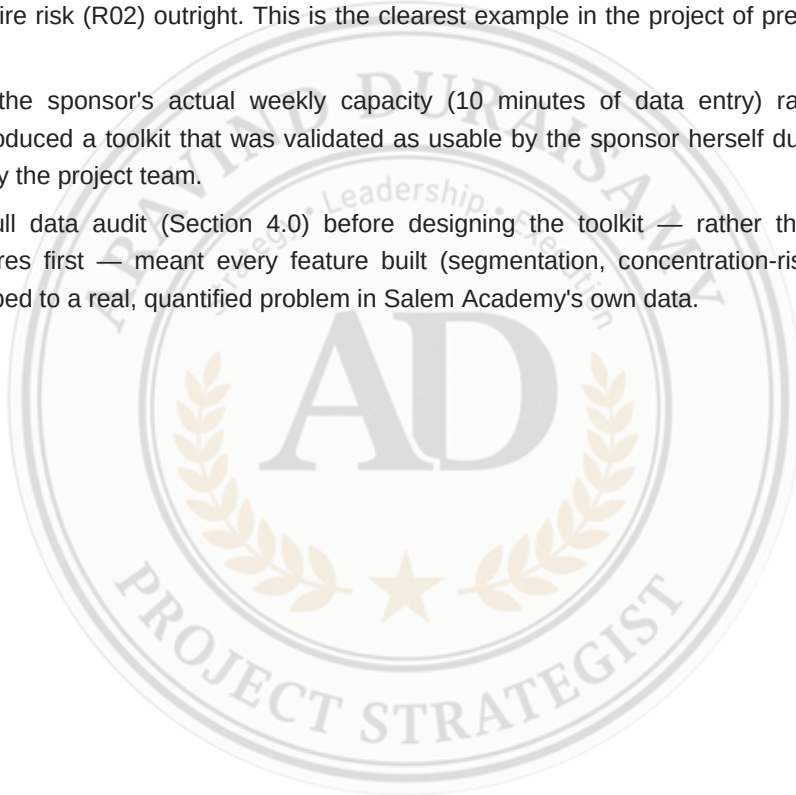
### 12.2 Future Scope Beyond the Current Toolkit

- **Address the 77% top-3 donor concentration risk directly** — the audit in Section 4.2 surfaced this as the school's single largest financial exposure; a mid-level donor cultivation program to diversify below the top three is a natural next phase of work, using the Donor Intelligence segmentation already built into the toolkit.
- **Convert lapsed donors into a structured re-engagement campaign** — 210 lapsed donors (38.7% of the base) already exist in the system with full giving history; the toolkit identifies them but a dedicated re-engagement campaign was outside this project's scope.
- **Multi-year revenue forecasting** beyond the current 18-month planning horizon, once two to three full annual cycles of clean tracker data have accumulated.
- **Board-facing reporting layer** built on top of the existing KPI dashboard, tailored for quarterly board updates rather than Fallon Burke's own operational use.
- **Direct Kindful-to-Excel data sync** (see RFQ above), removing the CSV export/import step entirely once budget allows.
- **Annual toolkit health-check** — a lightweight formula and data-quality audit (mirroring the Week 8 internal QA process used in this project) performed once a year to catch data drift before it compounds, addressing the eleven data-quality issues catalogued in Section 4.4.

## 13.0 Lessons Learned & Recommendations

With the project complete and the toolkit live, performance data supports the following recommendations for Salem Academy and future capstone teams working with similarly time-constrained nonprofit sponsors:

- The asynchronous-first communication approach worked well for a time-constrained sponsor — future teams working with small nonprofit clients should adopt a similar model rather than defaulting to frequent live meetings.
- The EMV-based contingency reserve request (23.8 person-hours) provided a credible, data-backed justification for schedule buffer. The buffer was never consumed, validating the underlying mitigation strategies rather than the buffer itself.
- Building the Kindful CSV import format into the architecture in Week 2 — rather than retrofitting it later — eliminated an entire risk (R02) outright. This is the clearest example in the project of prevention outperforming correction.
- Designing for the sponsor's actual weekly capacity (10 minutes of data entry) rather than for feature completeness produced a toolkit that was validated as usable by the sponsor herself during both training and UAT — not just by the project team.
- Running the full data audit (Section 4.0) before designing the toolkit — rather than designing generic fundraising features first — meant every feature built (segmentation, concentration-risk flags, recurring-gift messaging) mapped to a real, quantified problem in Salem Academy's own data.



## 14.0 References

This project's risk and quality management methodology was aligned with PMBOK 6th Edition principles. Prospect research drew on publicly available nonprofit-sector databases.

- Project Management Institute. (2017). *A guide to the project management body of knowledge (PMBOK guide)* (6th ed.). Project Management Institute.
- Internal Revenue Service. (2025). *Form 990: Return of organization exempt from income tax* [Salem Academy Charter School filing, FY2025].
- Foundation Directory Online. (2026). *Foundation and grant prospect research database*. Candid.
- GrantStation. (2026). *Nonprofit grant opportunity database*.



## Appendix A — Functional Requirements (Full)

| ID   | Requirement                                                                      | Priority | Final Status         |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|----------------------|
| FR01 | Provide summary of fundraising revenue by channel based on FY25 audit & Form 990 | High     | Met                  |
| FR02 | Identify key strengths, gaps, and opportunities in current fundraising strategy  | High     | Met                  |
| FR03 | Track all active/planned campaigns: name, goal, actual raised, status, timeline  | High     | Met                  |
| FR04 | Auto-calculate % of goal achieved; flag campaigns behind target                  | High     | Met                  |
| FR05 | Track corporate/event sponsorships: name, level, amount, status, renewal date    | High     | Met                  |
| FR06 | Flag sponsorship renewal dates ≥60 days in advance                               | Medium   | Met                  |
| FR07 | Maintain curated list of 15–25 mission-aligned foundations                       | High     | Exceeded — 20        |
| FR08 | FCT (Fit, Capacity, Timing) prioritization scoring per prospect                  | High     | Met                  |
| FR09 | Pipeline status tracking: Prospect → Researched → Contacted → Applied → Decision | High     | Met                  |
| FR10 | 12–18 month grant/campaign calendar with deadlines                               | High     | Exceeded — 14 months |
| FR11 | Recommended next steps and timelines per grant opportunity                       | Medium   | Met                  |
| FR12 | Summary dashboard: YTD performance, % of goals, campaign breakdowns              | High     | Met                  |
| FR13 | Visual charts for campaign performance, pipeline, and trends                     | Medium   | Met                  |
| FR14 | Accept Kindful CRM CSV exports as primary data input                             | High     | Met                  |
| FR15 | All deliverables in editable formats with user documentation                     | High     | Met                  |



## Appendix B — Non-Functional Requirements (Full)

| ID    | Category        | Requirement                                               | Final Status                                     |
|-------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| NFR01 | Usability       | System operable by non-technical staff without IT support | Met — confirmed Week 11 training and Week 12 UAT |
| NFR02 | Usability       | Weekly data entry ≤ 10 minutes                            | Met — confirmed by Fallon Burke                  |
| NFR03 | Compatibility   | Works within Excel and Kindful without new software       | Met                                              |
| NFR04 | Documentation   | Kindful import guide provided                             | Met — additional deliverable                     |
| NFR05 | Handover        | All files provided in editable formats via Google Drive   | Met                                              |
| NFR06 | Maintainability | Formula-based, macro-free logic throughout                | Met                                              |
| NFR07 | Performance     | Dashboard updates complete in under 5 seconds             | Met — ~3 seconds actual                          |
| NFR08 | Reliability     | Zero formula errors across all tracker sheets             | Met                                              |
| NFR09 | Privacy         | No PII stored beyond what is strictly necessary           | Met — no unnecessary donor PII retained          |
| NFR10 | Continuity      | Annual grant-calendar refresh process documented          | Met — Annual Refresh Guide delivered             |
| NFR11 | Data Quality    | Import issues flagged rather than silently corrected      | Met — 11 issues documented (Section 4.4)         |

## Appendix C — Team Charter Summary

The full Team Charter, signed by all five members on April 13, 2026, established the team's Scrum values (Commitment, Focus, Openness, Courage, Respect), a weekly role-rotation schedule across Project Manager, Scribe & Compiler, QA & Formatting, External Communication, and Support & Documentation, and a defined communication cadence: Microsoft Teams as primary channel, weekly team meetings, and response-time expectations of 6 hours on weekdays and 12 hours on weekends. Conflicts were to be resolved through direct conversation first, escalating to the Project Manager as neutral mediator only if unresolved within 48 hours.

## Appendix D — Ethics Statement

The team affirmed commitments to honesty and transparency in reported data and findings (including explicit documentation of data gaps and limitations — see Section 4.4); strict confidentiality of all information shared by Salem Academy, including financial and donor data; respectful and culturally sensitive engagement with Fallon Burke and school staff; full academic integrity with proper citation of external sources; data privacy limiting stored donor PII to what deliverables strictly required; no conflicts of interest with the sponsor organization; and responsible use of AI-assisted tools in drafting, with all outputs reviewed, validated, and owned by team members before submission.